



SMALL BUSINESS

How To Use A Family Office To Drive Meaningful Growth

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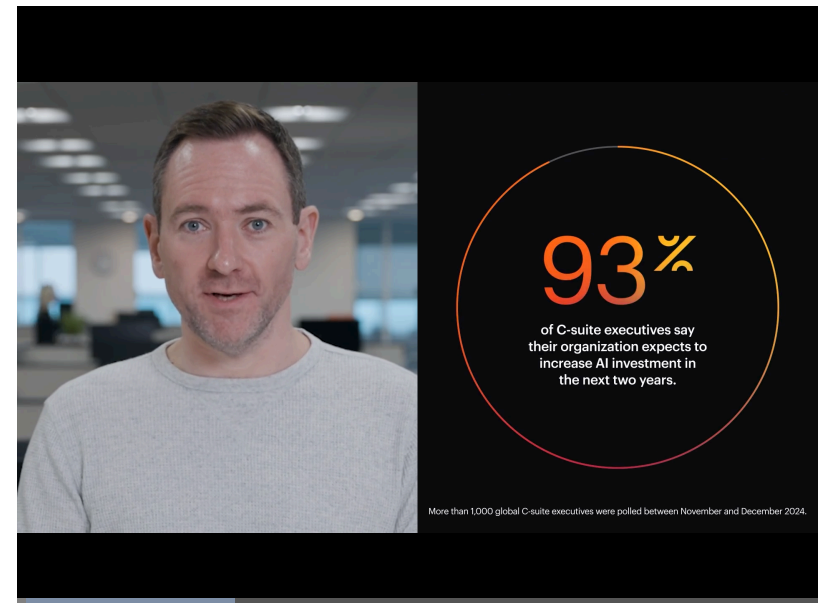
How To Use A Family Office To Drive Meaningful Growth



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Jean-Pierre Conte is a business leader, philanthropist, and the founder and managing partner of [Lupine Crest Capital](#).

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When my parents came to the United States, neither of them had capital, but they had conviction about what was possible and about the value of building something that lasts. That instinct is in my bones. It's why, after decades of investing in companies across healthcare, software, financial services and industrial technology at a private equity firm, I created my family office through which I deploy personal capital into the same sectors I know deeply, backing strong companies and strong people. Here's what I've learned:

Experience And Patience

After more than 30 years, the most valuable thing I've accumulated is experience. With experience, you can read a management team quickly, you develop instincts about markets that are backed by decades of learning and you can build relationships with founders who call you first. These are all things that matter immensely when making direct bets on companies with personal capital, and I'm not alone.

According to Citi Wealth's [2025 Global Family Office Report](#), 70% of respondents had made direct investments in private companies. These aren't newcomers to private markets. They're seasoned investors who have reached a stage where they can act on everything they've built, with clarity that larger structures don't always allow.

Patience is the other half of it. While every investment still needs a real thesis and genuine discipline behind it, patience shows up here in the ability to give a company the runway it actually needs rather than the runway that's convenient. And the family office structure often allows for this. Together, when you take these building blocks of experience and patience, you begin to see what this model is really about and how it can lead to great dealmaking.

What Hasn't Changed

The fundamentals of good investing don't change with the structure: sector depth over breadth, relationships before transactions and, above all, people. Every thesis eventually comes down to the team executing it. I've seen strong markets fail to save weak management. I've seen exceptional leaders build remarkable companies in brutal environments. Find the right people, back them fully, give them room.

What my family office gives me is the ability to do that job without compromise, relying on the accumulated experience and same patience. Here, I'm following the same sectors, standards and belief that backing the right people in the right businesses creates outcomes that matter—for investors, for the companies themselves and for the people those companies serve.

Three Takeaways For Business Leaders

For others looking to take the leap into building a family office, here are some tips:

Deploy what you know.

The investors who create lasting value aren't spreading themselves across unfamiliar territory—they're going deeper into sectors where they've spent years building real knowledge. Whatever stage you're at, the most powerful thing you can bring to a company is your understanding of the industry you're trying to serve.

Put people first.

Every investment comes down to the team executing it. Before you commit capital, commit to an honest assessment of the people because they are what you're really backing.

Understand what patience actually means.

Patient capital isn't passive capital. It's the decision to give a great company the time it needs rather than the time that's convenient. Knowing when to hold is as important as knowing when to move.

My parents came to the United States to build. My family office is an extension of that idea.

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